



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

does free
will explain
all evil?

Suppose that we can block Mackie's argument by revising our view of God's omnipotence.

One might think that a problem remains. There's a different way in which God could have given us free will while preventing the evil to which it actually gives rise: God could have only ever given us choices between alternative actions which lead to no evil. Suppose, for example, that we only ever had choices between different flavors of jelly beans.

Doesn't this possibility deliver the conclusion of Mackie's argument by itself, without the help of any assumptions about omnipotence?

We could try instead:

But this definition seems too strong.
Consider the action ‘Jeff Speaks freely
eating a hamburger for lunch.’ I can bring
this about — but God cannot.

Suppose that we reject (2). This raises the question: what is omnipotence, if not the ability to bring about anything possible?

onenighttry:

But this seems too weak.

A being is omnipotent if it can do anything that it is possible for that being to do.

A being is omnipotent if it can do anything that it is possible for any being to do.

Perhaps:

A being is omnipotent if it is as powerful as it is possible to be.

Suppose that we can block Mackie's



omnipotence.

argument by revising our view of God's

One might think that a problem remains. There's

freewill while preventing the evil to which it

actually give rise: God could have only ever given

beans.

ever had choices between different flavors of jelly

to no evil. Suppose, for example, that we only



a different way in which God has given us

Doesn't this possibility deliver the conclusion

omnipotence?

help of any assumptions about

of Mackie's argument by itself, without the

this about - but God can not.

creating a hamburger for lunch. can bring

Consider the action J_{eff} Speaks freely

But this definition seems too strong.

omnipotence, if not the ability to

bringing about anything possible?

Suppose that we reject (2). This

raises the question: what is



the basic
idea

does free
will explain
any evil?

God. It can explain that, it seems, if we make the following assumption:

there could be evil in a world with a omnipotent and perfectly good

Summing up so far: we have seen that Frege will promise to explain how

there are possible
situations which an
omnipotent
being cannot
bring about



we have
free will



free will is
a great good

the ability
to harm others
is a great good

does free
will explain
any evil?

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "does free will explain all evil?" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font, arranged in three lines.

does free
will explain
all evil?

**Free will
cannot
explain any
evil.**

Free will can
explain some
evil; but it can't
explain all of the
evil we find in
the world.